

Teacher Guide & Answer Key

60 SECONDS TO READY

01 ANSWER KEY

QUICK REFERENCE

VOCABULARY

1 – C 2 – E 3 – A 4 – D
5 – B

TRUE OR FALSE

1 F 2 T 3 T 4 F 5 T

LANGUAGE IN CONTEXT

1 cut corners 2 a crutch 3 erode
4 grapple with 5 at the expense of

TRUE OR FALSE · EVIDENCE

1 once “a privilege of wealthy families,” now open to “anyone with a phone” · 2 struggle “is often the learning itself” · 3 they “did worse... once the tool was taken away” · 4 “None of this settles the argument” · 5 fluency rising “at the expense of thought”

CRITICAL THINKING · ONE STUDY, SIX HEADLINES

No single right headline. Every one is technically true; the lesson is what each omits. Likely answers: 1 drops the forgetting; 2 drops the higher scores and adds blame; 3 turns “scored higher” into “learn faster”; 4 turns a finding into a fear; 5 is fair but tells readers nothing; 6 adds a verdict the study never made.

02 TEACHER GUIDE

BEFORE CLASS

AIM

Weigh short-term gains against long-term learning, analyze how framing shapes a finding, and defend a policy under challenge.

LENGTH

60–75 minutes.

TIP

Keep the debate off “cheating.” The harder question is honest use that still skips the learning. Rebutting groups attack the policy, not the presenters.

EXTENSION

Write a seventh headline for the study that is accurate, fair and still makes people click.

03 DISCUSSION NOTES

GUIDE THE TALK

STUDENTS MAY MENTION

struggle as learning · dependence · equal access · plagiarism vs. honest use · calculators & the internet · what exams actually measure

FOLLOW-UP QUESTIONS

- If a tool helps you pass but not remember, has it helped you?
- Would you trust a doctor who trained with AI? What would you want to know?
- Who gains most from AI in schools: students, teachers, or the companies that sell it?

ENCOURAGE THIS LANGUAGE

“That rests on the assumption that...” · “I’d concede that..., but...” · “The flaw in that argument is...”

04 MODEL WRITING

SAMPLE ANSWER

There is a strong case that AI is simply the latest tool to be feared unfairly. Calculators did not destroy mathematics, and students who use AI well can move quickly past routine tasks toward harder ideas. For a motivated learner, a tireless tutor is a gift, not a threat.

Yet speed is not the same as understanding. Much of learning happens when we **grapple with** a problem long enough to feel lost, and a tool that removes that struggle can quietly become **a crutch**. The student who scores well with help but cannot manage without it has gained performance **at the expense of** knowledge.

The danger is not mainly dishonesty. Some students will always **cut corners**; that is nothing new. The deeper risk is honest, well-meant use that still skips the difficult part, and so begins to **erode** the very skills school exists to build.

I would therefore agree, with one qualification. AI makes students faster at producing work, not smarter at thinking. Whether it can do both depends less on the technology than on whether teachers design tasks it cannot finish for them.